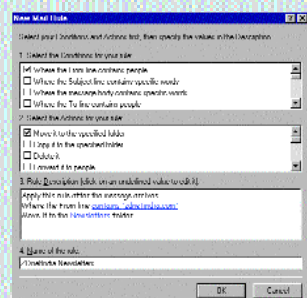


I spend most of my morning sorting through heaps of mail and newsletters.

Sorting through mountains of mail is a morning ritual for most of us, but the process can be streamlined. Both, Outlook and Outlook Express, and most other e-mail clients, host powerful automatic filtering features. Called Mail Rules or Mail Filters, these tools determine how to handle incoming mail based on a few defined parameters. They can sort your mail depending upon the sender—the newsletters from ZDNetIndia.com will be stored in a particular folder, while all the spam mail from spammers.com will be automatically deleted.

To set up rules, click **Tools** > **Message Rules** > **Mail**. Click **New** to create a new rule. Select the criteria (say, 'Where the From line contains people') and click on



Create rules for your mail

the criteria in the Rule description box. Here you can add the specific values for the criteria (e.g. zdnetindia.com). Similarly, select the action for the rule (Move it to the specified

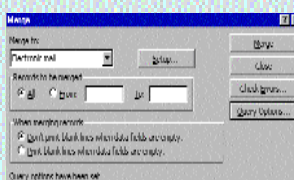
folder), click the action item in the Rule Description box and enter its value. Enter a name for the rule and you're done. You can even set up multiple criteria and multiple actions for rules.

One really cool utility lets you separate the e-mail you receive from a particular account (say, company account) from the rest. To do this, set up the rule as 'Where the From line contains people' and enter the company's domain name (e.g. jsubhai.com). Click **Options** and choose 'Message does not contain the people below'. Set the action to move the message to a specified folder and choose a folder to store the messages. Now your corporate e-mail will come into your Inbox and other messages will wait in the other folder till you find the time to sort them.

My boss asked me to send this letter to all our customers in Delhi. He asked me to e-mail those who have e-mail access.

This task is very simple if you have the list of customers in a database. Microsoft Excel is the easiest to work with, so request your database operator to give you the list in Excel. Type your letter in Word, leaving blanks where the customer's information (name, for example) should appear. In Word, open **Tools** > **Mail Merge**, and click **Create** > **Form Letters**. Click **Active Window** and then **Get Data** > **Open Data Source**. Select the Excel

file and then edit the document. The Mail Merge toolbar will automatically appear. Click **Insert Merge Field** to insert the customer's name. You can filter out the residents in Delhi in the Excel sheet itself, or when extracting the list from the original database or even from the Mail Merge function itself. Once you've added all the fields, click the Mail Merge icon. Select **Merge to Printer** and click



Filter data before merging it with the document

Query Options. Here, set the criteria to select only the people who don't have e-mail addresses (select the E-mail column under **Field** and set the Comparison to 'is blank') and set the city to Delhi if you want. Click **Merge** to print all the letters. Similarly, select **Electronic Mail** in the 'Merge to' options and set the query to pick up only the records that have an e-mail address. These can be sent automatically via e-mail. Again, open **Tools** > **Mail Merge** in Word. This time select **Create** > **Envelopes** (or Mailing Labels). Following the same process as above, you can print envelopes (or labels to stick on the envelopes) for those who will be receiving the printed letter.

My temp who enters all these forms into the database is quite slow. He's probably never used Access.

Give the data entry operator a form on the screen that looks similar to the form he's entering data from. In Access, open the database



Make Access user-friendly with forms

and click the **Forms** tab. Click **New** and select **AutoForm: Columnar**. Access will automatically create a data entry form that is linked to the table. Once the form is created, you can rearrange the text fields to look exactly like the paper form—just drag the elements to the correct positions!

Every time I go out, they just start surfing the Internet. The other day he was looking at... ugh!

The Internet can be an excellent resource for research and information; however, it can also be a distraction, bringing down productivity. This can be controlled in Internet Explorer without having to install any additional programs. Open **Control Panel** > **Internet Options**. Under the **Content** tab, click **Enable** and enter a password—you will be asked for this password every time you modify the settings. Click **Settings** to set up what sites

Ad will come